



GREY BANNER ALERT



mainroads
WESTERN AUSTRALIA

SHW Serious Incident (SI) – Final Notice

Date of Incident	16 January 2024	Time of Incident	14:10
Directorate / Region	Metro	Main Roads or Contractor	Main Roads
EQSafe Event Type	Health	EQSafe Incident Number	37044
Actual Consequence	Moderate	Potential Consequence	Major

Incident Short Description	Worker suffers thermal stress, resulting in MTI/LTI
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Executive Summary

Whilst undertaking brush cutting works, a routine maintenance worker (Injured Person) IP has begun to feel the effects of forecasted extreme hot weather.

The IP has walked towards a work vehicle to take a break when a crew member has noticed that they were struggling and has assisted them to the vehicle. The IP has then sat in the air-conditioned vehicle, where the crew member has provided first aid, using a wet rag to cool the face and neck.

The crew member has then contacted the Supervisor to notify and seek further advice. The IP's condition has continued to worsen so the crew member has then taken them to the nearest hospital for medical assessment.

The IP has remained in hospital overnight for medical treatment and observation, where it was determined that an underlying medical health condition has been exacerbated due to thermal stress.

Contributing Factors

- The Metropolitan region was in the middle of a forecasted three-day heatwave, with a high of 42 degrees recorded on the day of the incident.
- The IP was not aware, through his senses, of the onset of thermal stress.
- The IP recognised that he did not drink enough water throughout the morning to keep his body hydrated.

Corrective Actions

- Recommendation for all Maintenance Crews to complete their Senior First Aid training, as it has been proven to be invaluable in high-risk situations.
- Managers and Supervisors to aware of workers whose underlying health conditions may be aggravated due to certain tasks and conditions, and to roster them accordingly.

Additional Issues / Learnings

- Where possible, non-essential maintenance tasks to be rescheduled around extreme weather events. However, the nature of the work means that this risk cannot be fully avoided.
- Medications may have an impact on how the body reacts to thermal stress.

Critical Risk:

This serious potential incident aligns with the Main Roads Critical Risk Profile relating to **Thermal Stress.**

Distribution of Notice

Main Roads Personnel and Contracting Organisations